

Harvey Vault Set Up and Use

Step-by-Step Guide: Using Harvey Vault for legal education tasks.



Vault is best used as a controlled document workspace for extracting, comparing, and verifying information from a defined corpus — not as a shortcut around legal judgement, source checking, or educator responsibility.

Use the Harvey Vault to create a bounded, searchable corpus of materials, then use Harvey to organise, extract, compare, and draft material for human review. Do **not** treat Vault output as authority until it has been checked against the source documents and any relevant legal database. This is consistent with the Harvey familiarisation design principle that users should test outputs against legal method, source verification, privacy obligations, and pedagogical purposes.

Document Set up

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	Define the purpose	Decide what the Vault is for before uploading anything. Examples: case comparison, assessment moderation, lecture-note updating, issue spotting, authority checking, or cohort-level analysis of submissions.	A narrow use case.
2	Check the data boundary	Confirm whether the documents may be uploaded. For student work, remove names, student IDs, file metadata, comments, and any other personally identifiable information. Student submissions uploaded to Vault must exclude PII.	A safe upload set.
3	Curate the corpus	Upload only the material needed for the task. For a teaching task, this might be two judgments, one statute, an approved source extract, or a set of anonymised student submissions. Avoid the “dump everything in and hope” method, because that way lies chaos, false confidence, and someone eventually saying “but Harvey said...”.	A bounded document set.

Vault Creation

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	Create a new Vault	Vaults are repositories for large-scale file storage, with pre-processing and indexing to support efficient querying and sharing. Open Harvey, go to Vault, and create a new Vault with a clear name, such as <i>Contracts - Australian Woollen Mills case summary</i> or <i>Admin Law - Sharma case comparison</i>.	A named Vault workspace.
2	Upload the files	Add the selected PDFs, Word documents, or other permitted files. Keep filenames meaningful e.g., Sharma_FCA_2021.pdf, Sharma_FCAFC_2022.pdf, Assessment_criteria_anonymised.docx.	Uploaded source documents.
3	Allow indexing / processing	Wait for Harvey to process the documents before asking questions. Once processing is complete, run a basic orientation query to confirm that Harvey is drawing on the intended documents.	Confirmation that the corpus is usable.
4	Run a source-identification check	Ask: List the documents in this Vault, identify their apparent document type, and flag any file that appears irrelevant to the task. Do not summarise the law yet.	A quick quality check of the Vault contents.
5	Ask a bounded first query	Start with a narrow task. Example: Using only the documents in this Vault, identify the procedural posture, legal issue, outcome, and key paragraphs for each judgment. Do not infer beyond the source text.	A first structured output.

Create a Review Table

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	Create a Review Table	Use Harvey's Review Table function where the task involves multiple files or repeated extraction. Review tables can extract structured data from multiple files, including issues spotted, authorities cited, and quality of application.	A table-based view of the corpus.
2	Build useful columns	Use the column builder to define exactly what to extract. Avoid generic columns like "summary". Prefer legal-task columns such as issue, authority cited, statutory provision, reasoning, application, error, omission, evidence of synthesis, or source paragraph.	A legally meaningful table structure.
3	Use custom extraction prompts	For each column, write precise extraction instructions. Example: Identify each authority cited in the document. Include the citation as written, the legal proposition for which it is used, and the paragraph or page reference if available.	More reliable, reviewable cells.
4	Use citations to verify cells	Click through the citations supporting each table cell. Cells in Review Tables are supported by citations, allowing users to verify extracted information against original documents and flag or edit cells.	Verified or corrected table entries.
5	Add manual notes where needed	Add manual columns for educator comments, moderation notes, verification status, teaching use, or risk flags. Manual input columns can support comments and moderation workflows.	A mixed AI-supported and educator-reviewed table.
6	Ask across the table	Once the Review Table is populated, ask comparative or synthetic questions. Example: Using only the populated table, identify the three most common issue-spotting omissions and give one anonymised example of each. Flag any uncertainty.	Pattern analysis or comparison.

Teaching and Learning Tasks

Step	Action	What to do	Output
1	Convert output into teaching use	Use verified outputs to draft seminar questions, worked examples, feedback themes, common-error notes, or revision activities. For student-facing use, avoid giving a complete model answer unless that is the intended teaching design.	A teaching artefact.
2	Document the workflow	Record what was uploaded, what Harvey was used for, what was checked, what was corrected, and what was not relied upon. This supports accountable use and aligns with the familiarisation material's emphasis on disclosure, verification, and human-led judgement.	A short audit note.
3	Share only where appropriate	If the Vault or table is useful to colleagues, share it only with the correct group and only after confirming data permissions, copyright/license conditions, and teaching relevance.	Controlled reuse.

Example Review Table structure for a case-law Vault

Column	Extraction instruction
Case / document	Identify the case name, citation, court, and year.
Procedural posture	State whether the document is first instance, appeal, special leave, judgment, reasons, submission, or commentary.
Core legal issue	Identify the main legal issue addressed in the document.
Key statutory provisions	Extract statutory provisions discussed, with section numbers.
Authorities cited	List authorities cited and the proposition for which each is used.
Holding / outcome	State the result, without adding commentary not supported by the document.
Reasoning	Summarise the reasoning in 3–5 concise points, with source references.
Point for teaching	Identify one aspect useful for class discussion.
Verification status	Manual column: verified / needs checking / incorrect / unsupported.
Educator note	Manual column for teaching or moderation comments.

Example Vault prompts

Initial corpus check

Using only the documents in this Vault, list each document, identify its apparent type, and flag any document that appears irrelevant to the task. Do not provide legal analysis yet.

Review Table extraction prompt

For each document in this Vault, extract the case name or document title, court or source, legal issue, relevant statutory provisions, authorities cited, outcome, key reasoning, and source paragraph references. Keep each cell concise. Do not infer beyond the source text. Flag uncertainty where the document does not provide enough information.

Teaching-use prompt

Using only the verified Review Table, draft five seminar discussion questions for later-year Australian law students. The questions should move from comprehension to comparison and evaluation. Do not provide model answers. Identify which table columns support each question.

Verification prompt

For each claim in the draft output, identify the supporting source document and paragraph, page, or citation. Flag any claim that is unsupported, incomplete, ambiguous, or requires checking against an external legal database.

Minimum safe-use checklist

Before using Vault output in teaching, assessment, feedback, or moderation, confirm:

Check	Question
Corpus boundary	Did I upload only the documents needed for this task?
Data protection	Have I removed PII and sensitive metadata where required?
Jurisdiction	Is the relevant jurisdiction explicit?
Source grounding	Can each legal proposition be traced to a source?
Verification	Have I checked citations, quotations, and legal characterisations?
Educational purpose	Does this support learning rather than shortcut the task?
Human judgement	Have I reviewed, corrected, and contextualised the output before use?

This document contains text generated by ChatGPT5.4 via Harvey AI [Grammar, spelling, syntax, library, vault]